



■ By Uday Mahurkar

They are just 220 km away from the hustle and bustle of Ahmedabad, but the 42 tribal villages of Amirgadh taluka in Gujarat's Banaskantha district could not be more apart. Isolated by the imposing Aravalli hills, there are tribals in the area who haven't even seen their district headquarters in Palanpur. Underdeveloped, beset

by water scarcity, stricken by poverty and prone to robbery, they are, however, undergoing a transformation.

For the past five years, the farmers of the region have been able to change their crop pattern for the better and have seen a vast improvement in their socio-economic

life. The 50,000-odd tribals in these villages owe the dramatic change to Gandhian Hasmukh Patel. The 59-year-old social worker, by his vision and commitment, has achieved something that the Government with its ever-expanding machinery could not. He has brought water to the

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